

Prahl Portfolio Work Log - October 9, 2026

Compiled summary for Friday, October 9, 2026 - focus: continuing the PrahL.dev Portfolio after the October 8 seven-key UI/UX Philosophy and interactive Core Beliefs record; independently verifying the United States Eastern date; running the customary project reader; extracting and studying all fifty-one pre-existing Portfolio PDF worklogs; rebuilding the desktop philosophy carousel as a stable six-face rotation system with mirrored rear staging; correcting repeated left-navigation, direction-reversal, sliding, and horizontal-flip failures; adding local navigation controls to inactive stacks; constructing a perspective-warped horizontal axis with curved joins and control cutouts; isolating active and inactive hover states; eliminating repeated-SVG gradient collisions and triangle artifacts; adding animated condensation-style contrails around Core Beliefs with click-driven highlights and idle pulses; introducing coordinated but section-appropriate accent systems across UI/UX Philosophy, My Core Beliefs, and My Workflow; replacing workflow photography with dark radial color fields; restyling workflow number tabs; refining philosophy copy, hierarchy, spacing, alignment, wrapping, and device placement; validating TypeScript, routes, rendered geometry, six mounted roles, hidden source imagery, and final padding; documenting commits 1048ada, 0234df0, 5fa4018, and 3515aaa; refreshing the Portfolio project snapshot; and generating the October 9 Portfolio PDF worklog.

Generated in continuity with the established Prahl Portfolio daily worklog cadence: compact opening summary, source-material section, baseline section, goal list, grouped work-completed sections, committed-source sequence, validation section, files-touched list, follow-up context, and output-artifact close.

This artifact covers Portfolio work performed after portfolio_worklog_october8.pdf and documentation commit ae4fb9e. The application work is represented by four October 9 commits on main, matching origin/main at 3515aaa before this documentation pass. No application-source edit, source commit, push, GitHub Actions dispatch, manual Hostinger synchronization, or production release was performed while generating this PDF. The documentation deltas are the refreshed portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt file and this root-level October 9 worklog.

Source Materials Reviewed

- Verified the United States Eastern date through an independent UTC-04:00 time query, which reported October 9, 2026 at 10:48:32 PM. October 9 remains within Eastern Daylight Time, so the filename and title use Friday, October 9, 2026 rather than an execution-host or UTC calendar date.
- Ran ./read_project.sh from /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio and regenerated portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt before composing this record. The refreshed snapshot contains 18,790 lines and 623,143 bytes of source, configuration, asset inventory, Git state, PDF inventory, and workflow context.
- Extracted all fifty-one pre-existing root-level Portfolio PDF worklogs with pdftotext and inspected the full archive with pdfinfo. Before this artifact, the series contained 294 PDF pages and 145,433 extracted words spanning July 11 through October 8, with same-day Part suffixes where multiple records were required.
- Compared the complete worklog set for filename cadence, title construction, opening-summary density, source and baseline framing, technical bullet voice, validation language, files-touched treatment, follow-up continuity, dated page footers, and output-artifact closure.
- Used October 8 as the direct chronological baseline because it documented the earlier five-visible-stack philosophy scene, seven-key controls, widened active card, responsive collapse, and first interactive Core Beliefs orbit. Used October 7 for the original three-stack Motion scene and September 29 Part 2 for the workflow imagery and Core Beliefs composition baseline.
- Inspected representative early, middle, and latest PDFs visually and reviewed archive-wide metadata. The mature artifact remains unencrypted US Letter at 612 x 792 points, PDF 1.4, Helvetica and Helvetica-Bold, compact black-on-white technical prose, Codex metadata, and a repeated dated page footer.
- Reviewed commits 1048adad455d16f4edbe2166e873e359a026d8f4, 0234df095dc0ee12fdeda4803b215637aeec3a16, 5fa401837484f1e777463c748e6ab6527b52854, and 3515aaa21278c0d20c3857592fe31399ee40ea29 through git log, commit bodies, file statistics, and final source.
- Reviewed the current implementations in app/UiUxDecisionShowcase.tsx, app/CoreBeliefsOrbit.tsx, app/page.tsx, and app/globals.css, plus the current project snapshot and live landing route.

Baseline Status Before October 9 Work

- The October 8 carousel presented five visible desktop stacks: one active center, two inner inactive stacks, and two outer inactive stacks. It did not yet model a complete six-sided rotational object with a rear-center face.
- Repeated left navigation and direction reversal could still cause a card row to slide, flip horizontally, or rotate through the wrong direction. Width animation and role wrapping remained vulnerable after several consecutive actions.
- Inactive stacks did not yet contain their own left and right triangle controls. Hover relationships between center controls, inactive stacks, and repeated SVG arrow definitions could leak visual state or create elongated tips and rotation artifacts.
- The horizontal carousel axis did not yet travel through all visible stacks with perspective bends, rounded joins, opacity transitions, and protected gaps around number and triangle controls.
- Core Beliefs had interactive star rotation and bubble emphasis, but no condensation-style paths to explain the orbit or provide a quiet invitation when the user had not rotated the formation.
- UI/UX Philosophy, My Workflow, and My Core Beliefs still relied on color treatments that were either too close to the surrounding greens, too muted to establish hierarchy, or too broad and rainbow-like for the landing page's dark forest context.

- Philosophy card copy, emphasis lines, device groups, and side-stack text required another hierarchy pass. Several long lines depended on legacy no-wrap exceptions, and the active device group remained too centered inside the wide card.

Goals for October 9

- Convert the five-visible-stack carousel into a coherent six-face system whose rear faces support rotation logic without competing with the front presentation.
- Make left and right navigation behave symmetrically across repeated actions and immediate direction reversals, preserving the accepted rotational motion instead of flipping or sliding.
- Give inactive stacks usable arrows and isolated hover feedback while keeping rear stacks noninteractive and visually subordinate.
- Draw a continuous perspective-aware carousel axis, keep it behind all controls, and prevent line bleed through translucent triangles and number boxes.
- Add subtle Core Beliefs motion trails that remain invisible at rest, highlight during star rotation, and periodically pulse at reduced strength when the formation is idle.
- Establish final accent roles for philosophy headers, key fills, and emphasized copy; coordinate supporting color systems in Core Beliefs and Workflow without letting those sections collapse into one identical palette.
- Improve philosophy text legibility and composition while protecting large background numerals, device media, project labels, navigation controls, and perspective behavior.

Work Completed - Six-Face Carousel Architecture and Motion

- Rebuilt desktop role assignment around exactly six mounted stacks: previous outer, previous inner, active, next inner, next outer, and rear center. The rear-center face completes the rotational topology even though it remains visually hidden.
- Reinterpreted the outer stacks as mirrored rear-side faces wrapping around the back of the carousel. They preserve the inner stacks' tilt language while using smaller horizontal and vertical scales plus deeper z placement to communicate the vanishing point.
- Settled the two rear-side faces at 2 percent opacity and the rear-center face at 0 percent. The rear center exists only to preserve role continuity; it never appears as a competing card behind the forward active stack.
- Disabled pointer actions and hover-driven border changes for every rear role. Front-facing active and inner inactive stacks retain their accepted interaction model, while rear geometry remains motion infrastructure only.
- Restored the proven role-based spring behavior after experimental fixes made leftward movement worse. The corrected sequence keeps one continuous rotational direction through wraparound rather than allowing a card to interpolate across the row or mirror itself.
- Corrected the first left action after rightward navigation by preserving directional intent during reversal. Repeated left actions, repeated right actions, and immediate right-to-left changes now share equivalent transition behavior.
- Kept width interpolation on the dedicated positioner while the stack owns rotateY, depth, origin, scale, and opacity. This separation protects the earlier fix that prevents width reflow from becoming a false horizontal flip.
- Preserved reduced-motion handling, project-link protection, active/inactive layout distinction, and the existing mobile single-column presentation while changing desktop role topology.

Work Completed - Inactive Controls, Axis, and Hover Isolation

- Added independent previous and next triangle buttons to both visible inactive stacks. Their actions join the same staged carousel command system without turning the entire rear half into actionable UI.
- Matched inactive header and number weight to the active stack while continuing to use opacity, perspective, and surface treatment for hierarchy rather than making inactive typography artificially thin.
- Scoped arrow hover feedback to the stack that owns the hovered control. Hovering an inactive triangle now highlights that inactive stack's normal border system without borrowing the center stack's stronger whole-group emphasis.
- Prevented hovering the center stack, center key, or center triangles from changing any inactive stack or inactive triangle. Active and inactive hover systems now remain visually independent.
- Eliminated repeated SVG identifier collisions by ensuring each arrow instance uses isolated definitions. This removed intermittent gradient reuse, elongated noses, and ghost artifacts during rotation.
- Added a horizontal axis beneath the number and triangle row, then split and masked it around number boxes and arrow shapes so translucent controls do not reveal lines through their interiors.
- Warped the axis across the six-face scene with straight stack segments, curved edge connectors, and deeper-order rear transitions. The front line bends near its edges to meet inactive segments rather than stopping abruptly.
- Tuned line opacity and color before each bend, extended the gradient approach farther into straight segments, softened corner joins, and trimmed triangle-tip intersections by several pixels.
- Closed the remaining tiny front-to-inactive gaps while keeping the axis behind every triangle. The final line reads as one continuous object without becoming brighter or thicker at the bend.

Work Completed - Core Beliefs Contrails and Idle Guidance

- Added ten rounded SVG contrail paths between the five circular bubbles, using paired curves to create a subtle condensation or cartoon-airplane language around the star.
- Positioned the trails farther from the star and shaped each curve around the circular bubble stack so paths do not cut through bubble borders or flatten the radial composition.

- Kept contrails at 0 opacity during the resting state. Clicking or tapping a non-top bubble activates the complete trail system in synchronization with the star and orbit rotation.
- Added a three-second idle rhythm for users who have not rotated the star. Each pulse reaches approximately half of the full rotation-highlight strength, then returns to transparent without changing selection.
- Preserved the brighter rotation color treatment even after lowering resting visibility. The trail system can remain nearly absent during reading while still becoming obvious during action.
- Disabled the decorative trail layer for stacked mobile layouts and reduced-motion preferences, protecting the simpler portrait composition and accessibility behavior.
- Fixed center-carousel hover leakage in the same commit so the newly active visual effects did not compound unrelated inactive-stack feedback.

Work Completed - Philosophy Accent System and Key Treatment

- Assigned seven distinct solid accents to the seven philosophy roles: 01 pink #ff4fa3, 02 cyan #00bfea, 03 orange #ff7a1a, 04 blue #6c9cff, 05 yellow #ffc928, 06 violet #c084fc, and 07 lime #78c83a.
- Ordered the accents so closely related hues do not sit directly beside one another in the seven-step sequence. The final order remains readable against dark green surfaces while retaining the energetic 1980s/1990s animation and arcade influence requested during exploration.
- Applied each accent to the stack header, the solid key filling, and the large underlined emphasis phrase inside populated cards. Selector numerals remain the established off-white #f3fff7 so the top row does not become visually noisy.
- Replaced the key's pale outline with a black-green border and retained border-only hover changes. Color belongs to the key body; hover does not introduce a second competing fill or gradient.
- Kept the key SVG reusable by passing a tone derived from decision number. The same tone mapping also reaches headers and card content through data attributes and CSS variables.
- Preserved 03, 04, 06, and 07 while iterating only the rejected 01, 02, and 05 values. The accepted final pass uses cartoon pink, arcade cyan, and golden yellow without changing the locked orange, blue, violet, or sewer-lime choices.

Work Completed - Philosophy Copy, Typography, and Device Composition

- Rewrote stack 01 to Reliably sleek. / Fully streamlined. / Never / Behind. Renamed stack 02 from Appealing to Eye-Catching while keeping its placeholder body.
- Rewrote stack 04 to Legible. / Perceptible. / Quickly / Actionable. Rewrote stack 05 to Every form factor. / Every device type. / No sweat. and removed its earlier question marks and extra fourth line.
- Renamed stack 07 from Adaptable to Satisfying. The final title sequence is Modern, Eye-Catching, Smooth, User-friendly, Responsive, Cohesive, and Satisfying.
- Changed all ordinary paragraph lines from muted gray to the same #f3fff7 used in number boxes. Colored third-line emphasis remains independently sized, uppercased, underlined, and mapped to the owning stack.
- Increased white copy to a shared responsive 46.2px-to-59.4px pre-transform range, removed older 04 and 06 size exceptions, increased line height to 1.3, and standardized interline gap at 0.3em.
- Applied the matched left inset to the complete paragraph rather than only its first two lines. Added an explicit minmax(0, 1fr) grid track so 04 no longer lets intrinsic text width expand the paragraph beyond the card.
- Scaled side-stack paragraph layers to 0.51 so they visually follow the active stack's 0.5 internal reduction after perspective is applied. The adjustment preserves size relationships without scaling unrelated controls.
- Right-anchored each active device-preview group as one unit, including frame, context copy, and project label. The final rendered card-to-slot right inset measured approximately 32.08px at the 1440px validation viewport.
- Right-aligned device context and project attribution within that group while preserving frame proportions, large-number depth order, foreground z-index, and established vertical positions.

Work Completed - Workflow and Core Beliefs Color Coordination

- Restyled the four My Workflow number tabs to use the philosophy number-box language: 128px desktop squares, full borders, off-white heavy numerals, dark layered surfaces, and responsive fallback sizing on small screens.
- Temporarily disabled the source workflow photographs by setting the image elements to 0 opacity, leaving the structure and assets intact for a later restoration decision.
- Replaced the visible workflow media treatment with four section-specific dark radial fields. Research uses forest green, Plan uses deep red-brown, Produce uses dark blue, and Analyze uses muted gold-olive.
- Added workflow tone data to the timeline items so each visual treatment remains explicit and maintainable rather than depending on positional selectors.
- Updated My Core Beliefs to a quieter mineral palette appropriate to the landing page: green #82a58d, cyan #628a99, amber #9b895f, rose #aa7968, and violet #8c8192.
- Applied each belief tone to its title and supporting accent treatment while preserving bubble structure, orbit motion, selection behavior, star artwork, and contrail animation.
- Kept the three section systems related but not identical: Philosophy carries the vivid seven-color focal palette, Workflow uses very dark atmospheric fields, and Core Beliefs uses restrained mineral accents.

Committed Source Sequence

- 1048ada - Rebuilt the UI/UX philosophy carousel as a stable six-face experience. Added mirrored rear-side roles, an invisible rear center, directional role continuity, restored spring navigation, and noninteractive rear behavior.
- 0234df0 - Refined UI/UX philosophy carousel interactions and depth styling. Added inactive arrows, stabilized direction reversal, introduced the perspective axis and control cutouts, isolated hover states, and removed SVG triangle artifacts.
- 5fa4018 - Enhanced Core Beliefs orbit motion and hover isolation. Added rounded double contrails, synchronized rotation highlights, half-strength idle pulses, mobile/reduced-motion protection, and stronger carousel hover separation.
- 3515aaa - Refined landing page color systems and UI/UX carousel presentation. Added final philosophy accents, reworked copy and typography, right-aligned device groups, restyled Workflow tabs and media fields, and updated Core Beliefs colors.
- Together the four commits move from carousel topology and motion correctness, through control-level depth and interaction polish, into Core Beliefs motion guidance and a coordinated landing-page color and typography pass.

Validation Summary

- Ran npm run check after refreshing the project snapshot; TypeScript completed successfully with no emitted files.
- Confirmed /, /projects/alla-vostra, /projects/cinerific, /aboutdev, and /articles each returned HTTP 200 from the active local Next.js server at 127.0.0.1:3000.
- Used Playwright with the installed Google Chrome binary at 1440 x 1100 and confirmed exactly six desktop stack nodes with previous outer, previous, active, next, next outer, and rear roles.
- Confirmed the active device group remains inside the card and measured its final right inset at approximately 32.08px.
- Confirmed Core Beliefs renders ten contrail paths and that sampled trails report 0 opacity during the resting state before click or idle animation visibility.
- Confirmed all four workflow source image elements report 0 opacity while their structural containers remain present. The first workflow number tab measured 128 x 128px with a 68px numeral at the desktop viewport.
- Ran source-scoped git diff --check against UiUxDecisionShowcase.tsx, CoreBeliefsOrbit.tsx, page.tsx, and globals.css with no whitespace errors. The generated snapshot preserves numbered blank source lines and therefore remains unsuitable for a repository-wide whitespace signal.
- Confirmed main and origin/main both resolve to 3515aaa21278c0d20c3857592fe31399ee40ea29 before worklog generation.
- Kept the local Next.js preview running after validation. No production deployment, remote mutation, or external publishing action was taken.

Files Touched and Artifacts

- app/UiUxDecisionShowcase.tsx - implemented six-face role continuity, rear staging, inactive controls, isolated SVG definitions, tone mapping, solid key fills, and decision-aware content styling.
- app/CoreBeliefsOrbit.tsx - added paired orbit contrails, rotation activity state, idle timing, and accessible animation coordination.
- app/page.tsx - revised philosophy titles and card copy, added Workflow tone metadata, and retained the final seven-decision order.
- app/globals.css - implemented rear perspective, axis geometry and masks, hover isolation, contrail animation, final palettes, paragraph hierarchy, side scaling, device alignment, Workflow tabs, hidden images, and Core Beliefs tones.
- portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt - regenerated through ./read_project.sh to capture commit 3515aaa, current sources, assets, configuration, Git state, and all fifty-one earlier root-level worklogs.
- portfolio_worklog_october9.pdf - created as the first October 9 Portfolio worklog at the repository root using the established no-Part filename.

Follow-Up Context

- Desktop philosophy now depends on exactly six mounted roles. The rear center is intentionally 0 percent opacity and rear sides are intentionally 2 percent; changing visibility can expose mirrored content behind the active face.
- Rear stacks are rotation infrastructure, not controls. Preserve their disabled pointer behavior and fixed border treatment unless the interaction model is deliberately expanded.
- Direction reversal relies on role continuity plus separated positioner and 3D transforms. Avoid recombining width, x/y motion, and rotateY on one Motion element.
- Inactive arrows own local hover feedback. Center-stack hover must not brighten inactive headers, cards, numbers, or triangles.
- The carousel axis is segmented and masked around controls. Any change to number width, triangle size, or stack coordinates should be followed by visual checks for tip intrusion, bend thickness, and center gaps.
- Philosophy number boxes intentionally remain off-white. Only headers, key bodies, and large underlined emphasis phrases use the seven vivid accent colors.
- Paragraph copy uses a widened internal span because the active foreground is scaled to 0.5. The side copy uses 0.51 to compensate for its different perspective; removing either scale will recreate the visible size mismatch.
- Device-preview groups are right-anchored with a 64px pre-transform inset, which resolves to approximately 32px in the validated active card. Preserve the transform origin when changing that offset.
- Workflow photographs are still present in source but visually disabled. Restoring them requires reconsidering whether the dark radial fields remain overlays or become fallback backgrounds.

- Core Beliefs contrails are transparent at rest, pulse every three seconds while idle, and brighten during rotation. Their mobile and reduced-motion suppression is intentional.
- As with prior Portfolio work, ask for a commit message before committing or pushing the refreshed snapshot or this PDF unless the user explicitly requests those operations.

Output Artifact

- Created /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio/portfolio_worklog_october9.pdf as the latest daily worklog for Friday, October 9, 2026, following the established month-name, non-zero-padded day, and no-Part first-record naming convention.
- Produced an unencrypted US Letter, PDF 1.4 document using Helvetica and Helvetica-Bold with Codex title, subject, author, creator, and producer metadata.
- Preserved the mature dense technical narrative, section ordering, black-on-white layout, fixed page margins, and repeated dated page footer used by the recent Portfolio worklog series.
- Source state reviewed: 3515aaa21278c0d20c3857592fe31399ee40ea29 on main and origin/main before snapshot and PDF generation.
- No application-source change, source commit, push, manual deployment, Hostinger synchronization, GitHub Actions dispatch, or production publish was performed as part of generating this PDF artifact.